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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 8

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Reporte de un objeto perdido

Officer: Good afternoon, Central Rail lost property office. My name is Priya. How can I help?

Passenger: Hi. I think I left a bag on a train earlier today, and I'm hoping someone has handed it in.

Officer: I'll do my best to trace it. We receive items from several stations, so I need to complete a report first. Then I can compare your description with today's deliveries.

Passenger: Of course. I wasn't sure whether to call the station where I got off or this central office.

Officer: Calling us is right. Station staff send recovered property here at the end of each shift. May I begin with your full name?

Passenger: Yes. It's Daniel Ashworth.

Officer: Could you spell the surname, please? The line isn't completely clear.

Passenger: Certainly. It's A-S-H-W-O-R-T-H.

Officer: Ashworth. Thank you. And what number should we use if the item arrives? A mobile is usually best.

Passenger: Yes, use 0161 496 0175.

Officer: Let me repeat that carefully: 0161 496 0175.

Passenger: That's correct. I can answer after four o'clock. Before then, a text message would be easier because I'll be in meetings.

Officer: I've noted that. Now, what exactly did you lose?

Passenger: I first described it as a suitcase when I spoke to the station, but that was wrong. It's actually a rucksack, the sort you carry on both shoulders.

Officer: A rucksack, not a suitcase. Is there a manufacturer's name or luggage label on it?

Passenger: The brand label has faded, but there is a small card with my initials in an outside pocket.

Officer: Good. What is its main colour?

Passenger: It's dark green. The straps are grey and one zip has a red cord, but anyone looking at the whole bag would call it green.

Officer: That should make it easier to identify. Where did you last see it?

Passenger: I had it when I boarded. I'm almost certain I left it on the train, on the luggage rack above my seat. I noticed it was missing only after I had crossed the platform and reached the taxi queue.

Officer: So it wasn't left on the platform or in the taxi.

Passenger: No. I checked with the taxi driver, and I hadn't put anything in the boot.

Officer: Was there anything distinctive or valuable inside?

Passenger: In the main compartment there was a laptop in a black protective sleeve. That is the most valuable item. There were also two library books, a blue jumper and a charger, but no cash or passport.

Officer: Please don't give me the computer password. Its make and serial number can be added later if we find a close match. For now, I'll record the laptop and the other contents. Let's move on to the journey. Where were you travelling from?

Passenger: From Manchester. I caught the direct service rather than changing at Leeds.

Officer: Do you know the departure time?

Passenger: It was the two o'clock train. It left a few minutes late, at about ten past, but it was scheduled for two.

Officer: And what day did you travel? You said earlier today, but I need the day written on the form.

Passenger: Today is Friday. I nearly travelled on Thursday evening, then changed my booking, so Friday is the date you need.

Officer: Thank you. Which carriage were you in?

Passenger: The quiet coach, carriage C. My reserved place was seat 43, beside the window.

Officer: Did you remain there for the whole journey?

Passenger: Yes, apart from buying tea. The rucksack stayed on the rack, which is probably why I forgot it when I left.

Officer: Finally, the form asks for the approximate value of everything in the bag. This does not need to be exact.

Passenger: The laptop is a few years old, so I wouldn't claim its original price. With the charger, clothes and books, I'd estimate the contents at around £400.

Officer: Four hundred pounds. That's much more plausible than the seven hundred shown on the incomplete station note, so I'll replace that figure.

Passenger: Yes, £400 is my estimate.

Officer: I have everything I need. This afternoon's train has not yet been searched at the depot. Once it is, staff will send us a list of anything recovered. Your reference number is L-P-5831; the number identifies the report, not the bag.

Passenger: Should I call again tomorrow if I haven't heard from you?

Officer: You may, although most matching items take one or two working days to reach this office. We will text first and then call. If we find it, you can collect it with photo identification or pay for secure delivery.

Passenger: That's reassuring. Thank you for your help.

Officer: You're welcome, Mr Ashworth. Keep the reference number somewhere safe, and we'll contact you as soon as a matching rucksack arrives.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Indicaciones para un festival comunitario

Good morning, everyone, and thank you for volunteering at this year's Riverside Community Festival. I'm Elena, the volunteer coordinator. The gates open in forty minutes, so I will explain what has changed, review the site and finish with the procedures we all need to follow. First, the programme. Several familiar attractions are returning. The food market will occupy the eastern path as it did last year, the evening concert remains on Saturday, and the fireworks display will close the event on Sunday. None of those three is new. This year we have introduced two additions. At midday on Saturday, a children's parade will travel through the grounds, with costumes made by local schools. We are also running craft workshops throughout the weekend in the main tent.

Those workshops and the children's parade are the two new attractions visitors may ask about. The festival is being held in Victoria Park, right in the town centre. There is another green space called Riverside Gardens beside the station, and some online maps have confused the two. Please make sure visitors know they need Victoria Park. Pedestrians should use the north and west gates; the smaller riverside entrance is reserved for performers carrying equipment. This year's event runs for three days. It begins at four on Friday afternoon and continues until eight on Sunday evening. In previous years we operated only on Saturday and Sunday, so returning visitors may expect two days. The longer programme gives us room for more than two hundred stalls without making the central paths too crowded.

When you sign in for a shift, collect your festival T-shirt from the volunteer desk behind this platform. Wear it over your own clothes so visitors can identify you. Waterproof jackets are available if necessary, but they remain festival property and must be returned. The cap in your welcome pack is optional; the T-shirt is the item every volunteer should collect. Let us look at the site. The main stage is beside the lake in the centre of the park. The ground there slopes gently, so spectators at the back can still see. The smaller acoustic stage is near the rose garden, and the children's storytelling area is inside the library tent. If someone simply asks where the main performances happen, direct them towards the lake. The food market begins along the eastern path and continues towards the south gate.

Vendors may unload vehicles there until ten in the morning, after which the route must remain clear. Drinking-water points stand at both ends of the market. Volunteers should not recommend a particular food stall, but you can direct visitors with allergies to the information boards listing ingredients. Parking causes the most confusion. No visitor cars are allowed inside Victoria Park. The public car park is at the sports centre across the road, not at the swimming pool two streets away. It has accessible bays near its entrance. Drivers pay the normal parking charge, while bicycles can be left free at racks beside the north gate. The forecast currently predicts rain on Saturday afternoon. Light rain will not alter the programme, so visitors should bring suitable clothing.

If conditions become unsafe, however, outdoor performances will move into the marquee near the west gate. The concert will not move to the sports centre, and craft activities already inside the main tent will continue there as planned. The event manager will make any weather decision and send it to volunteers by text. Safety is everyone's responsibility, but call a supervisor rather than handling a

serious incident alone. The first-aid post is marked with a white flag beside the main entrance. For a minor lost item, take the visitor to the general enquiries desk. A child separated from their family requires a different procedure: bring the child directly to the information tent. Trained staff there will record details and contact the safeguarding team. Never announce a child's full name over a public radio.

There are toilets near each main gate, including accessible facilities at the west gate. A quiet space is provided behind the craft tent for visitors who need to leave the crowds. Dogs are permitted on leads, except inside food preparation areas. These details are printed on the pocket map you will receive after this briefing. The final point concerns fundraising. Stall fees cover the operating costs of the festival. All additional money raised this year goes to the local hospital, specifically towards equipment for its children's ward. Last year we supported the community theatre, so please do not repeat that older information. Donation boxes are sealed and should be taken only by volunteers assigned to the finance team.

At the end of each shift, return your radio to the volunteer desk and tell the next team about unresolved problems. You may keep the T-shirt. If your replacement has not arrived, speak to a coordinator rather than leaving an entrance unattended. I will now distribute the site maps and shift lists. Check that your phone number is correct, collect your T-shirt, and ask me privately about any duty you cannot perform. The gates open shortly, and with clear information from all of you, visitors should have a safe and enjoyable festival.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Tutoría sobre un plan de negocios

Tutor: Come in, Sam. I've read the first draft of your business plan for a mobile bicycle-repair service. The concept has potential, but some decisions need stronger evidence. How do you feel about it?

Sam: I'm excited, although writing the plan showed me how much I still need to investigate. Repairing bikes is familiar; predicting a business is less so.

Tutor: Let's begin with your reason for choosing this idea. Your introduction says you have repaired bicycles as a hobby for years. Was the plan simply a way to turn that hobby into employment?

Sam: The experience means I have the technical skills, but it wasn't my main reason. I noticed a gap in the local market. There are many cyclists here, yet hardly any repair shops, and none offers a mobile service. A friend liked the idea when I mentioned it, but she didn't suggest it.

Tutor: So the local gap is the central motivation. That is stronger than saying you have always wanted to own a company, especially since you told me last term that self-employment was not your original goal.

Sam: Exactly. People with a broken bicycle often cannot transport it across town. Going to them solves a practical problem.

Tutor: Your market research should demonstrate that those people will pay. You surveyed thirty members of your cycling club. Thirty is not necessarily too few for an initial exercise, and the questions themselves are clear. What weakens the result?

Sam: The participants are all enthusiastic cyclists. Many can perform simple repairs themselves, and they spend more on bicycles than the average resident. They aren't typical customers, so their answers may not represent the broader market.

Tutor: Correct. Ask commuters, parents who cycle with children and occasional riders as well. You do not need hundreds of responses, but you need a more varied sample.

Sam: I can speak to people at the station cycle racks and send the questionnaire through two local employers.

Tutor: Good. Now pricing. Your draft proposes charging less than established repair shops. Explain the reasoning.

Sam: I assumed a low price would attract people to an unfamiliar service. But once I added fuel, travel time and replacement tools, the low rate barely covered my costs. I now think I should charge the same as competitors and compete on convenience.

Tutor: I agree. A free first repair would bring attention, but it could also attract customers who never return, so do not build the plan around that. Match the normal repair price and state any travel fee clearly.

Sam: I could waive the travel fee within three kilometres and charge it outside that area.

Tutor: Test that idea in your survey. You also mention online retailers selling spare parts cheaply. Opening a physical shop would create rent, and trying to undercut large retailers on components is unrealistic. What advantage can they not easily copy?

Sam: I can visit the customer at home or at work, inspect the bicycle and fit the part there. An online seller can deliver a component, but it cannot provide that mobile repair service.

Tutor: Precisely. Make home visits the centre of your response to online competition. You can still order parts online yourself when appropriate; the value you add is diagnosis and installation at the customer's location.

Sam: I'll make that distinction clearer.

Tutor: Let us turn to risk. You list established shops, your limited business experience and seasonal demand. Which one worries you most during the first months?

Sam: Poor cash flow. I am confident in my repair skills, and the established shops are far away. The immediate problem is timing: I must pay for tools, insurance and a van before I have many customers. Money goes out before enough comes in.

Tutor: A realistic concern. You can reduce it by buying only essential tools initially and keeping a reserve for fuel and parts. Now we should improve the written document. At present, a reader has to reach page four before understanding the whole service.

Sam: So I need an executive summary at the beginning.

Tutor: Yes. In the plan itself, label it simply “Summary”. Keep it short and place it at the very beginning. It should identify the customer problem, your mobile solution and the amount of start-up finance required.

Sam: I can draft that after revising the other sections so it reflects the final plan.

Tutor: That is sensible. Next, the financial section contains annual totals but does not show when money enters and leaves the business. Add a monthly cash-flow forecast for the first year. The month-by-month pattern matters because winter demand may be lower while several costs remain fixed.

Sam: I'll create the forecast with a cautious sales estimate and a second scenario if demand grows faster.

Tutor: Good. Your product description is detailed, but the reader still cannot tell who will buy it. Add a description of the target customers. Commuters may form the largest group, but include parents and leisure cyclists if your revised survey supports that.

Sam: I had written about the general cycling population. I'll replace that with specific customer groups and explain what each one needs.

Tutor: Then add a section on marketing. At the moment, there is no plan for how those groups will hear about you. Local employers, cycling clubs and notices near transport hubs may all help, but estimate the cost and likely reach of each channel.

Sam: Social media could show before-and-after repairs, while agreements with employers might produce repeat bookings at one location.

Tutor: Finally, arrange insurance before accepting any paid work. It must cover accidental damage to a customer's bicycle and public liability while you work at their property. A promise to be careful is not enough protection.

Sam: I had budgeted for vehicle insurance, but not the business cover. I'll obtain three quotations this week.

Tutor: Excellent. To confirm your priorities: broaden the survey, keep the repair price in line with competitors, emphasise home visits, model the cash-flow risk, then add the summary, forecast, customer, marketing and insurance material.

Sam: I'll revise everything and send you the new version next Wednesday.

Tutor: That gives us time to review it before assessment. Bring the survey results as an appendix so your decisions can be traced to evidence.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: La historia de los relojes

Good afternoon. Today we will trace the history of clocks: humanity's long effort to divide the day into dependable units. Our story moves from shadows on the ground to mechanisms carried across oceans and finally to the vibrations inside electronic devices. It is useful to remember that societies did not replace one instrument everywhere at the same moment. Old and new methods often coexisted for centuries. For this overview, the earliest device we will consider is the sundial. Ancient civilisations used several forms, from a simple upright stick to carefully marked stone surfaces. The moving shadow indicated how far the day had progressed. Such devices helped organise work, ceremonies and public activity, although their divisions were not always equal to our modern sixty-minute hours.

The principle was straightforward. As Earth turned, the apparent position of the sun changed, causing a pointer's shadow to move across marked lines. The method could be surprisingly effective when the instrument was designed for its location. Its weakness was equally clear: it depended on the position of the sun. At night it produced no reading, and clouds or a poorly chosen position could make the shadow difficult to see. A sundial also had to be oriented correctly rather than simply placed on any flat surface. Communities therefore developed instruments that did not rely directly on daylight. One important example was the water clock. Water flowed at a controlled rate into or out of a vessel, and marks on the container indicated elapsed time.

The ancient Egyptians used such clocks, including for activities that took place after dark. Greek, Chinese and other societies later developed their own versions, sometimes with elaborate displays. Water clocks solved the night-time problem, but they were not perfect. Changes in water pressure could alter the rate of flow, and temperature could affect the liquid. Designers improved the containers and added mechanisms to maintain a more constant level. The important conceptual step was that time could now be represented by a regular process rather than by the visible movement of the sky. The next stage in our simplified chronology is the emergence of mechanical clocks in medieval Europe. The first large examples appeared in monasteries.

Monks needed signals for the prescribed hours of prayer, including times when no one wanted to watch a water level continuously. Weight-driven mechanisms gradually provided a more automatic solution. Similar machines later appeared in church towers and civic buildings, where an audible signal could regulate activity across a town. These early mechanical clocks looked very different from modern wall clocks. Many had no hands and no visual face at all. Their purpose was simply to strike a bell at the correct hour. The English word “clock” is itself connected historically with words for bell. Accuracy was limited; a mechanism might gain or lose a substantial amount in one day and require adjustment by observing the sun. Craft workers introduced refinements to control the release of energy from a falling weight.

Smaller gears and improved metalworking eventually made displays possible. Minute hands became useful only when mechanisms were accurate enough for minutes to carry practical meaning. Before that, announcing the approximate hour was sufficient for prayer, markets and communal routines. A major advance came in the seventeenth century. In 1656, the Dutch scientist

Christiaan Huygens built the first practical pendulum clock. Galileo had earlier studied the regular motion of pendulums, but he did not complete such a working clock. Giving Huygens credit for the 1656 instrument therefore does not mean he was the first person to notice the pendulum's useful properties. The pendulum swings in a highly regular way when its length and movement are controlled.

Connecting that motion to the clock mechanism made clocks far more accurate than most earlier designs. Instead of losing many minutes in a day, a well-made pendulum clock might lose only seconds. This improvement encouraged more precise scientific observation and made the minute hand a normal feature. However, a long swinging pendulum works best when it remains stable. It is unsuitable for a pocket and unreliable on a moving ship. Portability required another source of controlled energy. The coiled spring allowed a mechanism to operate without heavy hanging weights. Spring-powered clocks could be made smaller, eventually leading to watches carried on the body. Early portable pieces still varied with movement and temperature, but makers steadily improved them.

Accurate portable timekeeping became especially important at sea. Sailors could estimate latitude using the sky, but finding east-west position was much harder. To calculate longitude, a navigator needed to compare local solar time with the time at a known reference location. A difference of one hour corresponds to a predictable portion of Earth's rotation. The challenge was building a clock that remained reliable through changes in temperature, humidity and the constant motion of a vessel. Marine chronometers addressed these problems through careful engineering. Once reliable clocks could travel aboard ships, sailors could calculate longitude with much greater confidence. The clock did not tell them location by itself; it supplied the reference time needed for the calculation.

Industrial production later made accurate domestic clocks and watches more affordable. Railways added another pressure for standardisation. When journeys connected towns that had previously kept slightly different local times, published timetables required a common system. Timekeeping thus shifted from a specialised aid for astronomy or navigation to an organising framework for everyday life. In the twentieth century, many devices replaced mechanical oscillators with electrically driven systems. Most ordinary clocks and watches today regulate time using tiny crystals of quartz. When an electric current is applied, quartz vibrates at a highly stable frequency. Electronic circuits count those vibrations and convert them into seconds.

The material is inexpensive, compact and sufficiently precise for normal daily use. Quartz did not end the search for accuracy. Scientific laboratories use atomic clocks based on transitions within atoms, and networks compare these instruments across countries. They support satellite navigation, telecommunications and the international definition of the second. Yet the phone in a pocket still presents time through the same basic human idea found on ancient instruments: measuring a regular change and using it to organise experience. Next week we will examine atomic standards in detail, including why tiny timing errors matter for satellite positioning. For today, focus on the sequence of solutions: shadow, flowing water, mechanical regulation, the pendulum, portable spring power, marine navigation and quartz.